



United States
Attorney's Office
Western District of Washington



U.S. Attorney's Office Collects more than \$1.5 Billion in Criminal and Civil Actions in Fiscal Year 2024

Wednesday, February 12, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Western District of Washington

Criminal Payment by Crypto Exchange Binance for failing to have money laundering protections boosts collections to new record

Seattle -- U.S. Attorney Tessa M. Gorman announced today that the Western District of Washington collected \$1,518,145,143 in criminal and civil actions in Fiscal Year 2024. Of this amount, \$1,509,282,780 was collected in criminal actions and \$8,862,362 was collected in civil actions.

The Western District of Washington worked with the Criminal Division's Money Laundering and Asset Recovery Section and the National Security Division to obtain the [\\$1.5 billion payment from cryptocurrency exchange Binance](#).

"Our office worked closely with Department of Justice components on the criminal case against Binance, in which Binance pleaded guilty to failing to register as a money transmitting business, willfully violating the Bank Secrecy Act and willfully causing violations of U.S. sanctions," said U.S. Attorney Gorman. "That \$1.5 billion coming through our office, is part of the \$4.3 billion criminal fine and forfeiture. It is a record in the Western District of Washington."

Independently, the U.S. Attorney's Office for the Western District of Washington collected \$3.8 million in criminal restitution payments, and an additional \$8.8 million civil collections. Many of the criminal collections were for cases in which people intentionally failed to pay their income taxes. The owner of a string of coffee stands paid \$96,000 in restitution to the Internal Revenue Service for intentionally underreporting his income from the business. [A Snohomish County restaurant owner paid over \\$511,000 for tax fraud](#) and [a Tukwila restaurant owner paid \\$376,000 so that his \\$926,902 tax fraud debt was paid in full](#).

Of the civil collections, the district obtained \$217,000 following the sale of Dr. Frank Li's Spokane medical office building. The payment was applied to Dr. Li's \$2.85 million civil settlement for health care fraud.

Additionally, we collected \$1.23 million from Yakima Products, Inc. These payments (which were in addition to payments made in 2023) satisfied Yakima's \$3 million settlement with the United States, for failing to pay duties on aluminum components imported from the People's Republic of China. Learn more about the case here: <https://www.justice.gov/usao-wdwa/pr/automobile-accessory-company-yakima-products-inc-settles-allegations-failed-pay-duties>

The U.S. Attorneys' Offices, along with the department's litigating divisions, are responsible for enforcing and collecting civil and criminal debts owed to the U.S. and criminal debts owed to federal crime victims. The law requires defendants to pay restitution to victims of certain federal crimes who have suffered a physical injury or financial loss. While restitution is paid to the victim, criminal fines and felony assessments are paid to the department's Crime Victims Fund, which distributes the funds collected to federal and state victim compensation and victim assistance programs.

Additionally, the U.S. Attorney's office in the Western District of Washington, working with partner agencies and divisions, collected \$2,864,850 in asset forfeiture actions in FY 2024. Forfeited assets deposited into the Department of Justice Assets Forfeiture Fund are used to restore funds to crime victims and for a variety of law enforcement purposes. A large portion of the forfeitures relate to the indictment of two men operating a business that posted stolen items for sale via online websites. You can learn more about the case [here: https://www.justice.gov/usao-wdwa/pr/two-indicted-buying-stolen-goods-and-selling-them-online-amazon-or-ebay-more-3-million](https://www.justice.gov/usao-wdwa/pr/two-indicted-buying-stolen-goods-and-selling-them-online-amazon-or-ebay-more-3-million).

Contact

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Updated February 12, 2025

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